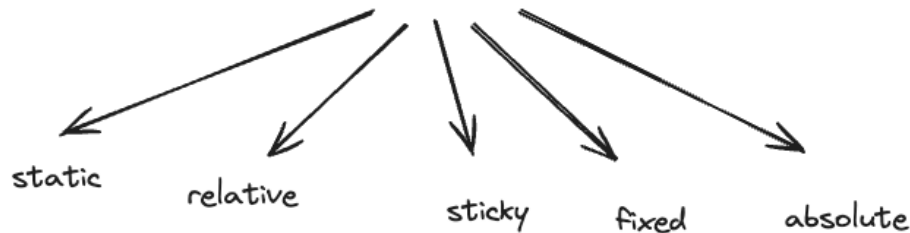


Position Property

CSS Positioning

The position property in CSS determines - How an element is positioned in a document.

It gives you more control over the layout of your page. Using the 'position' property, we can specify the type of positioning we need.



The CSS position property can possess one of the above 5 values.

After making a decision on what value the CSS position property we want to keep, we can then control some coordinates of our elements,

- top
- bottom
- left
- right
- z-index



These are some more CSS properties that are enabled for our elements after positioning is done.

Position:Static

Static is the default value of the position property in CSS. If we don't give any position value, then Static is automatically assigned to the element.

With static, element is placed according to the regular flow of document.

Now, because position: static maintains the default flow of the document, any helper properties for coordinates like top, left, right etc are not going to work.

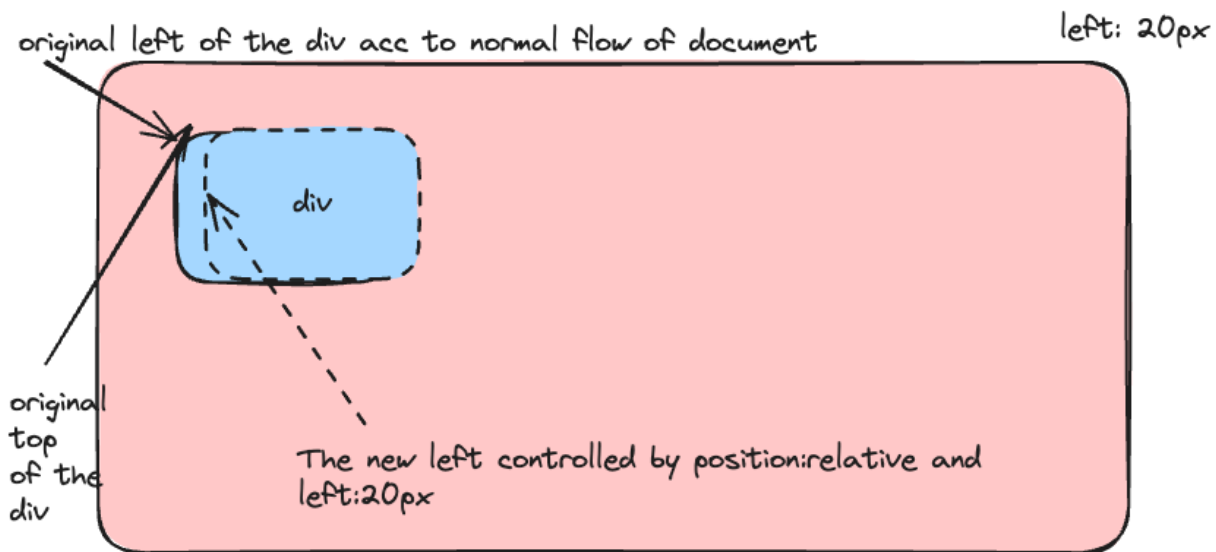
Moral of the story is, if we want to move the elements to a particular position, static is of no use.

position: relative

In position relative also, the element is by default placed according to the normal flow of the document.

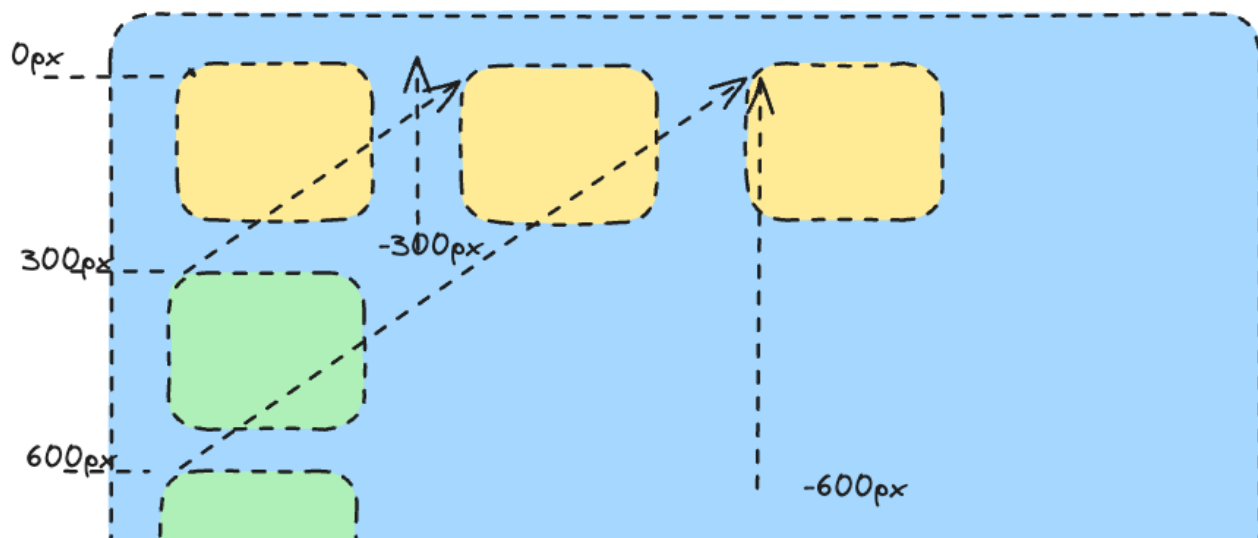
But the main difference from position static comes when we have to give the extra properties to control the coordinates of the element.

In a nutshell, relative sets the position of the element with respect to it's original position.



The elements in the document are arranged in a "normal flow" if we don't provide any position property to it.

But if we give position : relative then also it stays in the "normal flow" but, gets an enhanced capability to be able to move relative to it's normal flow (if we want)





Position: absolute

An element using position: absolute will be positioned relative to the nearest ancestor(this ancestor should be a positioned ancestor i.e. having a position value other than static.

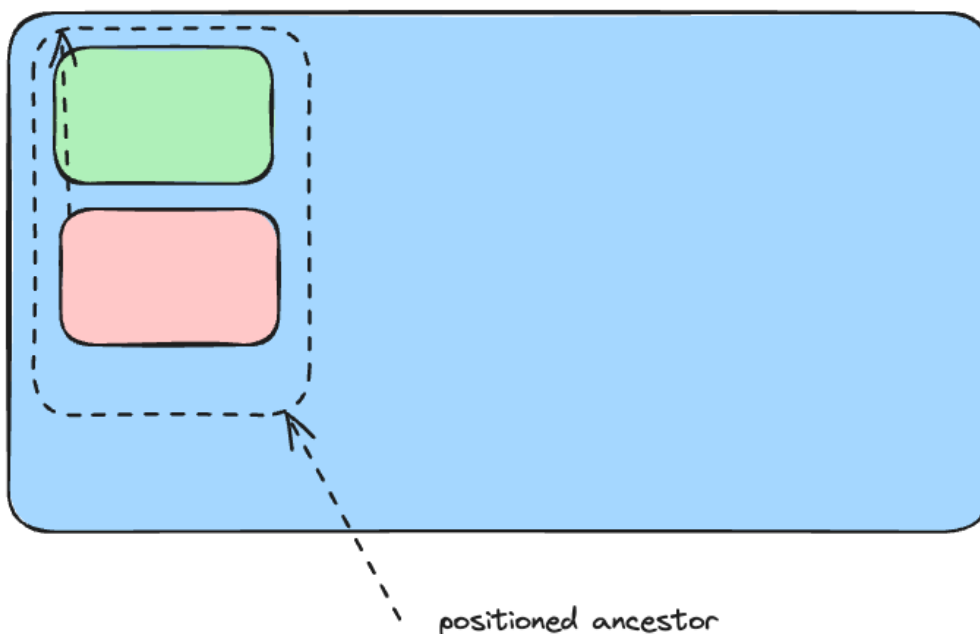
).

If an element is not having a parent element, it is places relative to the initial containing block.

We can use helper properties like left, right, bottom, top with absolute, but if we don't specify the left, right, top, bottom then element is positioned automatically to the top-left corner of the parent

Position absolute removes the element from normal document flow.

to be positioned w.r.t ancestor(positioned)



position: fixed

An element with position attribute having value fixed is also removed from normal document flow and then is positioned relative to the viewport.

The top, bottom, left and right helper properties will also be applied w.r.t viewport

The elements are not affected by scrolling, they stay in their exact same position even if we scroll the page.

position: sticky

Position value sticky is a combination effect of position: relative and position: fixed.

Initially during declaration, when there is no scroll done by user, the position: sticky will be acting as position: relative.

When the user attempts scrolling then position: fixed like behaviour comes.

A sticky element toggles between relative and fixed depending on the scroll position.

Z-index

While placing our elements on a webpage, there will be cases of overlap.

z-index specifies stack order of our elements.

only works with block

elements with
specified height



The CSS overflow property is used to adjust the content when its size is too big relative to the container element.

If we give overflow property a hidden value then overflow property clips off any overflowing content from the container.